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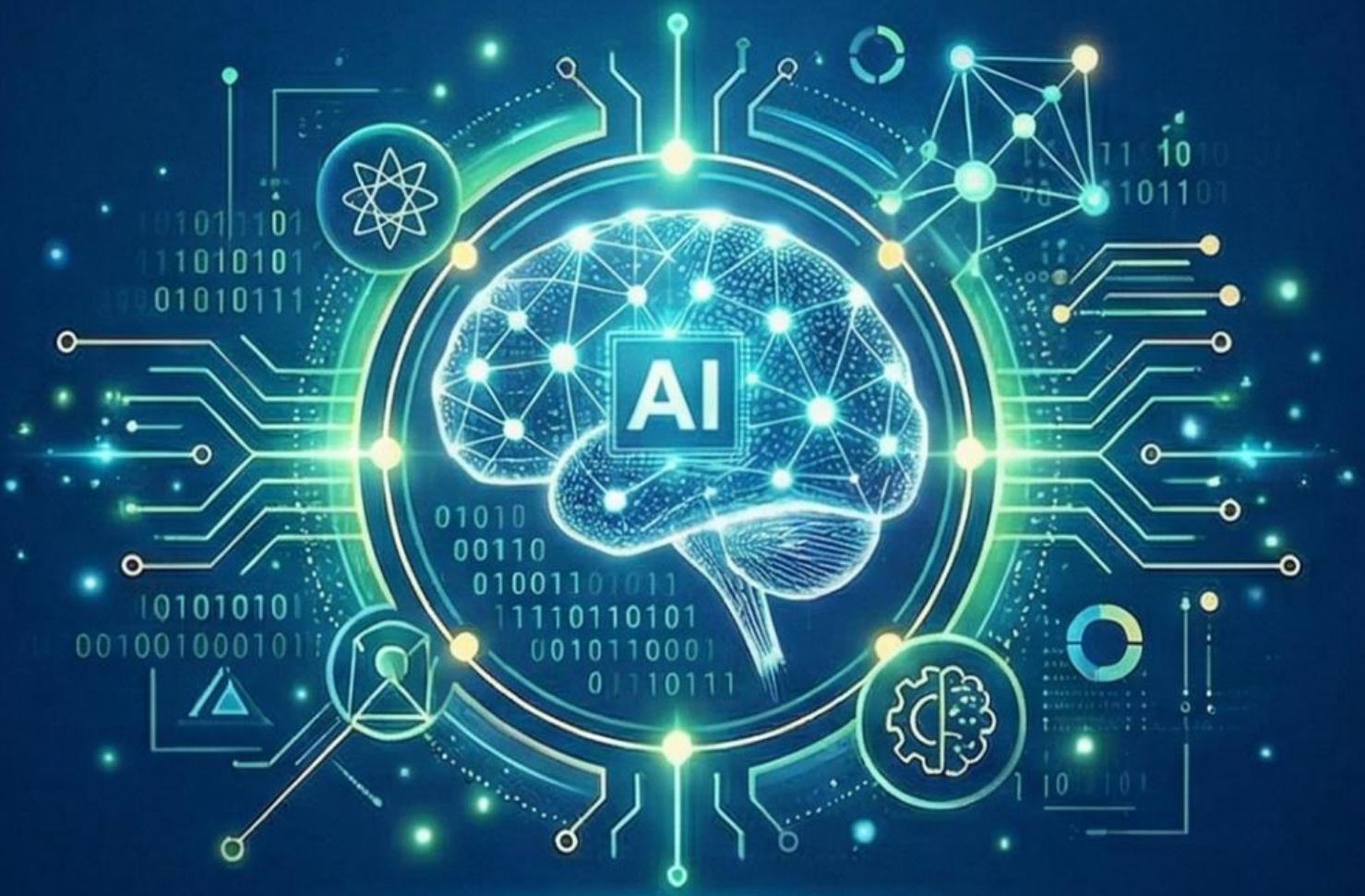

STUDENT DIGITAL AMBASSADOR PORTFOLIO

CSE0001: DIGITAL LITERACY

Project Assignment Report

Student Details:

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Year: First Year

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1. ***Introduction***

I have recently been selected as a Student Digital Ambassador for VIT Bhopal University. My primary role is to assist my batchmates in safely, professionally, and effectively navigating the modern digital environment. This portfolio serves as my first official assignment, designed to be presented to the faculty committee and shared with my peers. The project encompasses five key modules: understanding digital literacy, building a professional online portfolio, utilizing coding and collaboration platforms, mastering online communication etiquette, and preventing cybercrime. Through this comprehensive report, I document my journey of completing these tasks, highlighting the digital tools used, the technical skills acquired, and my reflections on establishing a responsible digital footprint as a first-year engineering student.

2. ***Task 1 Write-up: Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic***

For the first task, I created a Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic aimed at educating my batchmates. I utilized Canva (canva.com) to design the visual asset, as it offers excellent, easy-to-use presentation templates. My design highlights three core topics: a clear definition of digital literacy, a checklist for safe internet practices (such as using 2FA), and the importance of a professional online presence.

The most interesting part of this process was learning how to distill complex, text-heavy information into a visually appealing, one-page format without making it look cluttered. However, I found it somewhat difficult to choose exactly which digital tools to feature, as there are so many useful platforms available for students today. Ultimately, this task taught me that effective digital communication relies heavily on clear, concise visual design, ensuring the message is easily absorbed by the viewer.

3. ***Task 2 Write-up: Building a Student Digital Portfolio***

To build my foundational student portfolio, I set up professional profiles on GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. I chose GitHub to showcase my coding projects, particularly in Python, by utilizing a custom profile README that introduces who I am and what I am studying. I selected LinkedIn to begin building my professional network and to display my educational background at VIT Bhopal to future recruiters. Finally, I created a Kaggle account, which is highly relevant to my AI and Machine Learning specialization, to access datasets and practice building machine learning models.

Over the next four years of my B.Tech degree, my plan is to actively upload my academic and personal projects to GitHub to act as a live resume. I will connect with industry professionals, seniors, and alumni on LinkedIn, and participate in introductory data science competitions on Kaggle to build a strong, demonstrable skill set before graduation.

4. ***Task 3 Write-up: Exploring Coding & Collaboration Platforms***

For the coding and collaboration task, I created an account on HackerRank to practice my programming skills. I successfully completed the introductory 'Solve Me First' challenge using Python. Additionally, I built a 'Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz' using Google Forms, ensuring it included a mix of multiple-choice and short-answer questions, and linked it to a Google Sheet to seamlessly collect responses.

These tools will be incredibly beneficial to me academically. HackerRank will help me prepare for technical placement interviews and improve my algorithmic thinking through daily practice. Meanwhile, Google Workspace tools like Forms and Sheets will allow me to easily collect data for university club activities, survey my peers, and collaborate seamlessly on group engineering projects without needing to send files back and forth.

5. ***Task 4 Write-up: Professional Email & Etiquette Guide***

One common situation where poor digital communication causes real problems is when students email professors with overly casual language, missing subject lines, or lacking their basic registration details. For example, sending an email from a personal address that just says "Please extend the deadline" can come off as disrespectful and confusing. This often leads to the professor ignoring the email, resulting in the student missing the submission entirely.

Drafting the extension and internship emails taught me that this could easily be avoided by using a formal greeting, a clear subject line, and a polite request explaining the situation, followed by a professional sign-off. Taking an extra two minutes to format an email properly shows respect for the recipient's time and drastically improves the chances of getting a positive response.

6. ***Task 5 Write-up: Cybercrime Awareness & Prevention***

While researching UPI and online payment fraud for the cybercrime case study, I was most surprised by how heavily these scams rely on social engineering. Cybercriminals don't always "hack" complex banking systems; instead, they manipulate human psychology by creating a false sense of urgency or trust, tricking users into entering their PINs to receive money on marketplace apps.

As a result of this research, one habit I will personally change is my tendency to rush through digital transactions on my phone. I will now make it a strict rule to pause, read the screen prompts carefully, and verify the receiver's name before ever entering my UPI PIN. I now understand that a PIN is exclusively for sending money, a simple rule that is crucial for financial safety.

7. ***Conclusion***

This Digital Literacy project has significantly improved my understanding of what it means to be a responsible and capable digital citizen. Setting up a GitHub repository from scratch gave me practical experience in version control, which is essential for my computer science degree. I also learned that digital literacy extends far beyond just writing code; it involves communicating professionally, protecting my personal data against cyber threats, and actively managing the digital footprint I leave behind for future employers to see.

8. ***References***

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